

Anyone else worried about AI's energy consumption?

Posted by u/ItalianFurry • 0 points • 113 comments

I'm trying to reduce my energy consumption as much as i can, but it all feels vain against the sheer amount of energy AI is wasting. The amount of computation needed for a simple output is astonishing, and what's even worse is that people use it for stupid stuff. OpenAI literally uses the waste heat from their machines to heat up pools...

The fact that AI is getting included everywhere makes this even worse. I feel nauseous everytime i see AI included in a product, or when i see a new LLM out, knowing how much energy was wasted and will be wasted because of it...

Comments

u/FragrantClimate4299 • 1 points • 2025-06-19 16:58 UTC

[AI Energy Conundrum](https://youtu.be/V_hlk5-QpR8?si=5qfWiwuKO_uCE_c-)

u/Nobody_at_all000 • 1 points • 2025-05-10 20:40 UTC

I'm hoping research into analog optical computing might help alleviate that, since

1. matrix multiplication is one of the primary operations in artificial neural networks. This operation can be done easily with with optics, and since it's analog and not digital it requires way less complexity
2. Neural networks can be trained to be robust to small errors and perturbations, and doing so could potentially increase their generalizability as the neural network is forced to leave more robust representations

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2024-10-11 07:00 UTC

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u/EggyRepublic • 1 points • 2024-09-17 05:55 UTC

I would argue AI consumes (relatively) little energy, compared to things like manufacturing, transportation, etc. I believe ChatGPT uses something like the equivalent electricity rate of 10,000 - 20,000 households, which is miniscule since this service directly benefits millions (and billions indirectly). Or a different comparison: it takes a 500W GPU working around two weeks straight to generate the equivalent CO2 of producing one kilo of beef (60 kg CO2).

Basically my point is that in absolute terms, AI isn't using enough energy to really put a dent in global pollution levels. And from a cost-benefit point of view, I would argue the ratio of benefits to cost is insanely high. Personally, I've been able to learn concepts very fast and efficient compared to just

Googling, and even if a topic is too difficult for an exact answer, it can still point me in the right direction or give relevant suggestions that massively accelerate my search.

u/kombinacja • 1 points • 2024-09-08 19:20 UTC

I refuse to use generative AI for this reason

u/BeginningFloor1221 • 1 points • 2024-09-08 05:28 UTC

No

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2024-09-07 15:15 UTC

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